

Butterwort

Boggy parts of Europe, North and South America, and Asia. Sticky hairs on its leaves trap insects.

Monkshood

Mountains of the northern hemisphere. Also known as aconite, it is a source of a deadly poison contained in the seeds.

KEY



Poisonous plants

Some plants contain toxic chemicals. The map shows eight of the most poisonous.



Carnivorous plants

These plants trap and consume insects and other small creatures.



Incredible plants

Four amazing plants are highlighted on the map, but there are many thousands more worldwide.

Sundew

Worldwide in boggy places. Traps insects with droplets of glue coating its leaves.

Waterwheel plant

Africa, Asia, Australia, and Europe. Freshwater plant a little like an underwater Venus flytrap.

Nepenthes rajah

Borneo. This giant pitcher plant may sometimes catch rats or lizards to eat.

Rosary pea

Indonesia. Toxins are used in herbal medicines of southern India.

Deadly nightshade

Europe, north Africa, and west Asia

Castor oil plant

East Africa, Mediterranean, and India. Origin of the poison ricin.

Welwitschia

Namib Desert. Has just two straplike leaves. They can grow up to 20 ft (6.2 m) long over several centuries.

Rainbow plant

Australia. Catches insects on its sticky leaves.

Terrestrial bladderwort

Worldwide. Grows on wet, rocky surfaces and catches tiny prey in bladderlike traps.

World of plants

Scientists estimate there are at least 400,000 species of plants on Earth—and possibly many thousands more. Some parts of the world have a rich diversity of plant life; in others, such as Antarctica, plants are scarce.

1,500 YEARS, BUT IN THAT TIME IT GROWS ONLY TWO GIANT LEAVES.